CHANGE ORDER FORM

The Rate Guide — Freelancer's Contract Pack

Use this every time a client asks for something that wasn't in the original contract.

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

A change order documents scope changes after a project is underway. It protects both parties: the client knows exactly what the added work costs before it starts, and you have written authorization before you spend time on work outside the original contract.

The rule: never do out-of-scope work without a signed Change Order. No exceptions.

Fill every `[BLANK]`. Delete annotation text before sending. Attach this to the original Freelance Services Agreement — it becomes a binding amendment.

CHANGE ORDER

Change Order #: `[Number sequentially — CO-001, CO-002, etc.]`

Date: `[Today's date]`

Project: `[Original project name]`

Original Agreement Date: `[Date the original contract was signed]`

Contractor: `[Your Name / Business Name]`

Client: `[Client Name / Company]`

ORIGINAL SCOPE

As agreed in the Freelance Services Agreement dated [Date], the original scope of work included:

[Copy the relevant deliverables or scope description from the original contract. Be specific — this establishes the baseline.]

REQUESTED CHANGE

Client has requested the following addition or modification to the original scope:

Change Description:

[Describe the change clearly. What is the client asking for? One paragraph. Be specific about what's different from the original scope.]

Examples:

- *"Client requests a third revision round after the final cut was delivered. The original agreement included two revision rounds."*
- *"Client requests delivery of a 9:16 vertical social cut in addition to the contracted 16:9 edit."*
- *"Client requests a second shoot day to capture additional interviews not included in the original scope."*
- *"Client requests delivery of all raw camera footage from the shoot day."*
- *"Client requests a 30-second cut from the contracted 60-second spot."*

IMPACT ASSESSMENT

> **DECISION** *Fill in whichever of these applies. Not all changes have schedule and budget impact — a small revision might have only time impact. Be accurate.*

Time Impact: [Additional X hours / X days / no additional time required]

Delivery Date Impact:

- Original delivery date: [Date]
- Revised delivery date: [New date — or "no change"]

Budget Impact:

ITEM	HOURS / DAYS	RATE	TOTAL
[Work description]	[X hrs / X days]	$ [Rate]	$ [Total]
[Additional item if applicable]	[X hrs]	$ [Rate/hr]	$ [Total]

Change Order Total	$ [Total]

> **DECISION** *If the change has zero cost — for example, a legitimate second-round revision that's within the spirit of the original scope — you can note "No additional charge" here. But make them sign the form anyway. The signature acknowledges the change happened and that both parties discussed it. That documentation protects you if they later add a third and fourth "no charge" change.*

PAYMENT TERMS FOR THIS CHANGE ORDER

> **DECISION** *For small change orders under $200, you can add it to the final invoice. For larger changes, require partial payment upfront, especially with new clients.*

- **Option A:** Amount due with final invoice.
- **Option B:** [50%] ($ [Amount]) due upon signing this Change Order. Remaining [50%] ($ [Amount]) due with final invoice.

EFFECT ON ORIGINAL AGREEMENT

All other terms of the original Freelance Services Agreement dated [Date] remain in full force. This Change Order supplements — and does not replace — that Agreement.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

By signing below, both parties acknowledge:

1. The original scope has been expanded or modified as described above.

2. The additional compensation and revised timeline (if any) are agreed upon.

3. Contractor is authorized to begin the additional work.

4. No further out-of-scope work will proceed without an additional signed Change Order.

Contractor

Signature: _____

Name: `[Your Name]`

Date: _____

Client

Signature: _____

Name: `[Client Name]`

Title: `[Their Role]`

Date: _____

> ***The Most Important Thing About Change Orders***

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> *The conversation before the signature is the work. When a client asks for something new, your response is: "That's outside our original scope — let me write up a Change Order." Say it every time, without apology. Clients who are used to working with professionals will expect it. Clients who push back are telling you something important about how they'll behave on the next project.*

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> *Never do the work first and then send the Change Order. By the time the client sees the work, they've lost the urgency to approve new spend. The form goes first. The work starts after it's signed.*

Prepared with The Rate Guide Freelancer's Contract Pack. therateguide.com